

THE
BOOK OF RIDDLES.



CONCORD:
JOHN F. BROWN
1846.

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THE BOOK OF RIDDLES.



'Tis true I have both face and hands,
And move before your eyes,
Yet when I go, my body stands,
And when I stand, I lie.

A Clock.



My clothing's fine as velvet rare,
Though under earth my dwellings
are;
And when above it I appear,
My enemies put me oft in fear.
The gard'ner does at me repine,
I spoil his works as he does mine.
The Mole.



My form is beauteous to the ravish'd
sight,
My habit gay, my color gold or white;

When ladies take the air, I without
pride,
A faithful partner am close by their
side.
I near their persons constantly
remain,
A favorite slave, bound with a golden
chain;
And though I can both speak and go
alone,
Yet are my motions to myself
unknown.
A Watch.



Emblem of youth and innocence
With walls enclosed for my defence,
And with no care opprest,
I boldly spread my charms around,
'Till some rude lover breaks the
mound,
And takes me to his breast.
Here soon I sicken and decay:

My beauty lost, I'm turned away,
And thrown into the street;
Where I despised, neglected lie,
See no Samaritans pass by,
But numerous insults meet.
A Rose.



Two twins we are, and, let it not
surprise,
Alike in every feature, shape, and
size:
We're square, or round, of brass or
iron made,
Sometimes of wood, yet useful found
in trade;
But, to conclude, for all our daily
pains,
We by the neck are often hung in
chains.
A Pair of Scales.



I was before the world began,
And shall forever last;
Ere father Adam was a man,
Or out of Eden cast.
Your youthful moments I attend,
And mitigate your grief;
The industrious peasant I befriend,
To pris'ners give relief.
Make much of me if you are wise,
And use me while you may,
For you will lose me in a trice.
As I for no man stay.
Time.

The ancients represented time by the figure of a man, with broad wings, spread out, as denoting its flight, or that time is ever on the wing. In one hand he held an hour-glass, to show that as the sand, so our time is constantly running; and in the other, a scythe, to let us know that time, like the scythe, levels all. He is represented with only one lock of hair before, the remainder of his head being bald, to show that we must take him by the forelock, when it presents, lest when it be past, we find our disappointment, and as the back part of the head is bare, so our time is no more.

It foams without anger,
It flies without wings,

It cuts without edge,
And without tongue it sings.
A Bottle of Ale.



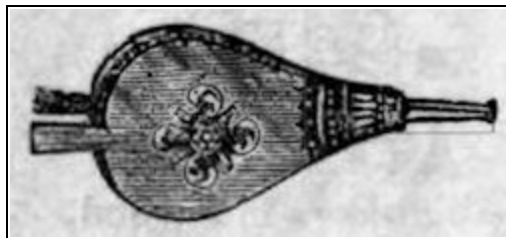
What force and strength cannot get
through
I with a gentle touch can do;
And many in the streets would stand,
Were I not, as friend, at hand.
A Key.

What is that which has been to-morrow, and will be
yesterday?

To-day.



My habitation's in a wood,
And I'm at any one's command;
I often do more hurt than good,
If I once get the upper hand:
I never fear the champion's frown,
Stout things I oftentimes have done;
Brave soldiers I have oft laid down,
I never fear their sword and gun.
A Barrel of Beer.



My nose is long, my back is broad
and round,
And in cold weather of great use I'm
found;
No load I carry, yet I puff and blow,

As much as heavy loaded porters do.
A Pair of Bellows.

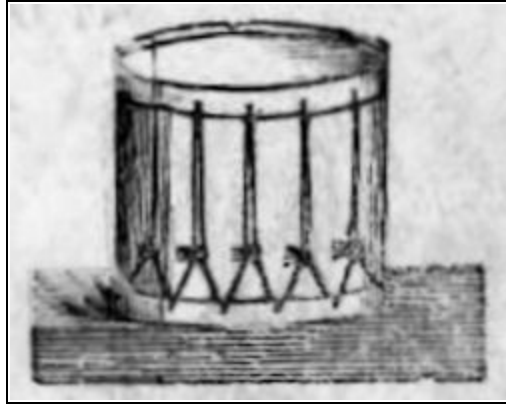


I never offend thee,
Yet thou dost me whip,
Which doth not amend me,
Though I dance and skip;
When I'm upright thou dost like me
best,
And severely dost whip me when I
want to rest.
A Top.



I'm a busy active creature,
Fashioned with a sportive nature,
I nimbly skip from tree to tree,
Under a well-wrought canopy;
And for cleanliness and air,
Am a pattern to the fair;
I, to arms and blood a stranger,
Apprehensive of no danger,
Like the ant, for winter store,
Searching, treasures to explore,
All on a sudden hear the foe,
The cause and object of my woe
By whom I'm soon a prisoner made
Chain'd, and in a dungeon laid:
Bid Chloe then, and Myra tell,
What's my name and where I dwell.

The Squirrel.

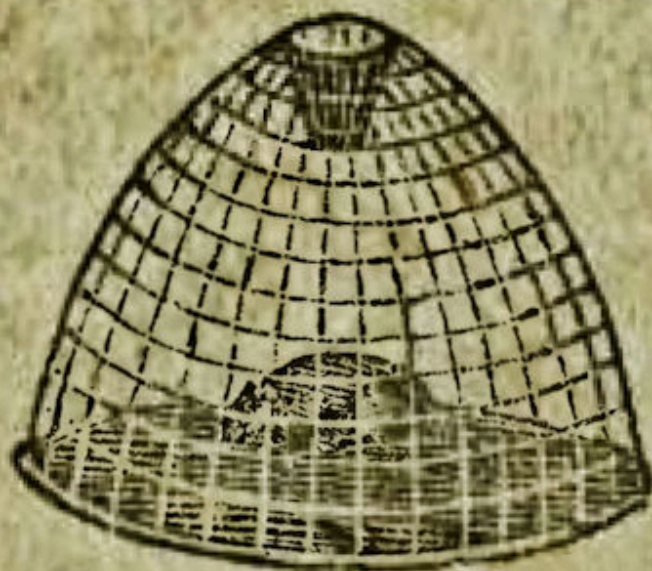
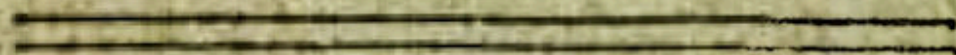
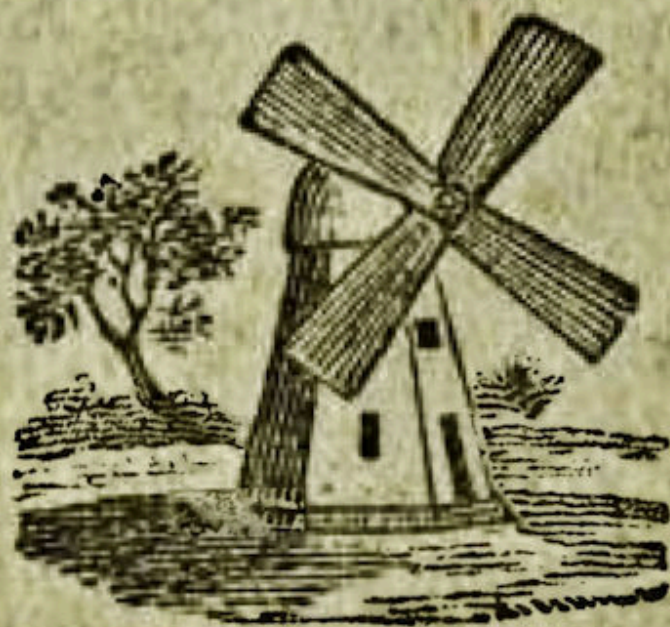


My body is light, my head is white,
With a cord I am laced around,
I am beaten with sticks, yet not for
bad tricks,
But to animate my sound.
The unthinking youth, who heed not
the truth
Which would save them from every
alarm,
To fight, kill, and die, and cause
much misery
To those who have done them no
harm.
A Drum.



Two bodies have I,
Though both joined in one
The stiller I stand,
The faster I run.

Hour-glass.



Transcriber's Note

- Punctuation errors have been corrected.
- Added missing answer for a riddle namely "[A Rose.](#)"

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